AUTONOMOUS REGION FOR NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

AR4NA Business Meeting Minutes

September 15, 2026

4:00 PM Pacific / 7:00 PM Eastern | Zoom

Opening

The meeting opened with the Serenity Prayer at 4:07 PM Pacific / 7:07 PM Eastern.

Members Present

Bill Fritz, Patrick Burns, Jon Arrigo, Jim Dugan, Alan Heisinger, Allen Jackson, Jacob Butki, Ann Premazon, Kate Gold, and Clay.

1. Current Fellowship Issues

Members discussed current developments within Narcotics Anonymous, including proposed literature changes and concerns regarding the relationship between Fellowship input, the World Service Conference, the World Board, and NA World Services.

Different perspectives were shared regarding regional motions, Fellowship participation, literature revision, and the effectiveness of the present world-service process. No action was taken.

2. IP on a Separate Service Structure

Alan H. proposed developing an informational pamphlet explaining why members see a need for a service structure separate from NA World Services.

The proposed IP will focus substantially on the NAWS corporate bylaws and corporate governance structure, including provisions discussed during the meeting concerning corporate membership and the authority of the NAWS Board of Directors.

The intent is to explain the documented structure in understandable language and explore why members believe a separate Fellowship service structure is desirable. Alan H. emphasized that the IP should be based on documented facts, citations, and source material so members can independently examine the information.

Members discussed beginning with a draft and developing the piece through discussion, review, input, and revision.

Action: Alan H. will prepare the initial draft for review and further development.

3. "What Is AR4NA?" IP

Members discussed the need for a clear introductory piece explaining AR4NA to members, groups, and visitors to the developing website.

The working framework for the IP is:

- WHO - Who is AR4NA?
- WHAT - What does AR4NA do?
- HOW - How does AR4NA work?
- WHY - Why does AR4NA exist?

The purpose is to provide a straightforward explanation of AR4NA, its purpose, its services, and how members and groups can participate.

Older website material may be reviewed for useful ideas or language, but the new IP will define AR4NA on its own terms rather than attaching it to another organization.

Action: Jacob B. will head development of the "What Is AR4NA?" IP. The draft will be returned to the group for review and input.

4. Website, Newsletter, and Member Communication

Members discussed continued development of the AR4NA website and the importance of having a clear public explanation of the Region before a larger launch.

The group discussed identifying approximately three to five key areas of focus so AR4NA presents a clear explanation of what it intends to accomplish.

Possible communication resources discussed included:

- the AR4NA website
- a newsletter
- a member blog
- member-written articles
- discussion pieces
- longer literature developed from those discussions

The newsletter and blog were discussed as places where ideas could be introduced, discussed, expanded, and potentially developed into larger pieces of literature. No final website structure was adopted.

5. Affordable Literature and H&I Access

Members discussed independently printed NA literature and the importance of making books available at prices that allow groups and H&I efforts to distribute substantially larger quantities.

Literature discussed included Fifth Edition and Sixth Edition Basic Texts, Third Edition Revised Basic Texts, Grey Books, and smaller editions suitable for H&I use.

Members shared experience regarding the usefulness of inexpensive literature in jails and other settings where standard retail prices can greatly limit the number of addicts receiving books. The emphasis of the discussion was on literature access rather than generating profit from literature sales.

6. Possible Sixth Edition Printing Project

Jon A. reported that an existing independent literature operation had recently placed an order for approximately 25,000 books. That existing printing operation and its finances are separate from AR4NA.

Jon A. raised the possibility of adding approximately 5,000 Sixth Edition Basic Texts to the printing run if AR4NA decides to pursue a literature project. He reported that the printer already has a print-ready file and that warehouse space and distribution infrastructure are available.

Members agreed that the current cost should be obtained before making any commitment.

Action: Jon A. will obtain an updated quote for approximately 5,000 Sixth Edition Basic Texts and report back to the group. No purchase was authorized at this meeting.

7. Literature Distribution and Shipping

Members discussed the practical requirements of a future AR4NA literature-distribution project, including:

- storage
- order fulfillment
- packaging
- Media Mail
- postage
- access to funds for shipping expenses
- use of existing distribution infrastructure

Jon A. indicated that his existing warehouse and literature-distribution operation could potentially handle additional inventory rather than requiring AR4NA to immediately create a separate fulfillment system. No final distribution arrangement was adopted.

8. Treasurer and Financial Procedures

Allen J. provided an informal financial update. Approximately $5,000 was reported as available in the AR4NA account, including a recent group donation of approximately $200. Because the figures were discussed conversationally rather than presented as a formal written treasurer's report, the balance should be considered approximate.

Allen J. explained that the account presently does not use a debit card and that web bill-pay has been used as a safeguard against unrestricted withdrawals.

Members discussed whether future literature and shipping operations may require another practical method for handling recurring expenses. No change to the current banking procedure was approved.

9. Pennsylvania Corporate Filing

Allen J. reported that AR4NA's Pennsylvania filings are being brought up to date and that one remaining filing needs to be completed.

Action: Allen J. will complete the remaining Pennsylvania corporate filing.

10. Pennsylvania Incorporation and Prior Literature Litigation

Members discussed the selection of Pennsylvania as AR4NA's state of incorporation and reviewed their understanding of earlier litigation involving independently reproduced NA literature.

The discussion included participant recollections and legal interpretations regarding prior litigation, literature reproduction, and the Fellowship Intellectual Property Trust. These statements represented views and interpretations expressed during the meeting.

No legal finding was adopted and no litigation action was authorized.

11. Establishing AR4NA's Initial Priorities

Members discussed the importance of focusing AR4NA's early development around a limited number of clear service priorities rather than attempting to undertake every possible service project at once.

Areas presently being developed or discussed include:

- defining AR4NA and explaining its purpose
- original AR4NA IP and literature development

- affordable literature access and distribution
- H&I support
- website and member communication
- newsletters and member writing
- Fellowship-development projects
- future events and gatherings

Members discussed identifying approximately three to five core priorities before a larger public launch. No final list or ranking was adopted.

12. Future AR4NA Gathering or Convention

Members discussed the possibility of eventually holding an AR4NA convention, gathering, or similar Fellowship event.

Ideas included rotating events among different locations and incorporating speakers, workshops, Fellowship activities, and service discussions. The idea was viewed as a future project rather than an immediate priority. No action was taken.

13. Email List Update

Kate G. is to be added to the AR4NA email distribution list so she receives future meeting notices, minutes, and other AR4NA communications.

Email: narelated@proton.me

14. Next Meeting

Members agreed to meet again in two weeks.

Next AR4NA Business Meeting

Tuesday, September 29, 2026

4:00 PM Pacific / 7:00 PM Eastern

Action Items

Responsible	Action
Alan H.	Prepare the initial draft of an IP explaining the desire for a separate service structure, highlighting the NAWS corporate bylaws and governance structure.
Jacob B.	Head development of the "What Is AR4NA?" IP using the Who / What / How / Why framework.
Jon A.	Obtain an updated quote for approximately 5,000 Sixth Edition Basic Texts before any purchase decision.
Allen J.	Complete the remaining Pennsylvania corporate filing.
Members	Continue identifying approximately 3-5 core

	AR4NA service priorities.
Members	Continue developing website, newsletter, blog, literature, H&I, and communication ideas.
Email List	Add Kate G. - narelated@proton.me.
Group	Reconvene September 29, 2026 at 4:00 PM Pacific / 7:00 PM Eastern.